

Design Rationale Document

Leadership Portfolio Redesign — DeepThought PM Internship Assignment

Submitted by: Harsh

What problem I was solving

The Leadership Portfolio currently functions like a monitoring dashboard: metric widgets arranged in a grid, all with equal visual weight. The problem with this is that when everything has equal weight, nothing communicates. An employee opening this page after a month of work should immediately know how they did, not hunt through six sections of equal-priority cards to piece together their own story.

My goal was to redesign the page so it feels like a personal career document, something an employee would be proud to show a mentor or a future employer, while keeping every data point mapped to a real backend field.

Design Challenge 1: The Signal

The biggest problem with the existing layout is the lack of a clear signal at the top. Experiment 1 tried metric concatenation ("42 of 54 delivered · 14 IP commits · 4/5 axes above threshold"), which reads like a log output, not a verdict.

My decision was to replace it with a single serif sentence addressed to the employee by name: "Rajan, this was a solid month. You shipped 78% of your planned work and grew in 4 of 5 areas." Paired with a gold left-border bar and an on-track status tag, this gives the employee their answer in under 3 seconds.

The tradeoff: a sentence is harder to scan quickly than a score ring or a grade. But a score ring (72/100) tells you nothing about what to feel. A sentence does. For a career document meant to be read, not monitored, the sentence wins.

Design Challenge 2: Story vs Data Ordering

Every section in my design leads with a narrative paragraph and follows with data. The narrative is the throughput; the data is the evidence.

The tradeoff here is between the employee and the supervisor. Employees want to read their story top-down. Supervisors want numbers first. I solved this with collapsible detail sections: the narrative and key stats are always visible, but granular breakdowns (IP commit log, blocker breakdown by type) are collapsed by default and expandable on demand. This way both audiences are served without building two separate views.

Design Challenge 5: Portability and Identity

The portfolio has a permanent UID that follows the employee even after they leave the organisation. This means it needs to make sense to someone who has never heard of PDGMS: a mentor, a future employer, or the employee's future self.

I decided to treat the top of the page like a document cover: employee name in large serif type, role and program below it, and month and UID visible in the metadata row. Anyone picking this up cold immediately knows who it belongs to, what they do, and when it was generated.

I also replaced all internal jargon throughout the page. IP Commits became Knowledge Contributions, Rituals became Engagement, QA Pending became Awaiting Review, and V-levels were labelled as "Senior Contributor (V2)" rather than raw codes. The internal tag is preserved in brackets for organisational context, but the label does the work for an outside reader.

Assumptions I made

- Employee name, role, and program are sourced from the user session/auth layer, not the portfolio endpoint, consistent with the data model document.
- • Narrative paragraphs are server-generated and passed as strings. I rendered placeholder narratives to show how they should be displayed.
- • The 6-axis threshold for V3 eligibility is 60 points per axis. I used this to position the threshold marker on the capability bars.
- • KPI data and constraint breakdown numbers are illustrative but match the shape and field names in the data model exactly..

What I would do differently with more time

- Add a previous/next month navigation so the portfolio feels like a living career record, not a one-off document.
- Build a supervisor view mode where data leads and narrative is collapsed by default, solving the dual-audience problem more completely.
- Add a "share this portfolio" button that generates a clean public URL using the permanent UID, making portability a feature, not just a design principle.
- Explore a mobile layout since employees are likely to open this on their phones between meetings.